

CA 527. History of Film

Fall 2019 Class Meetings: Thursday 1-4:50, Room P456

Instructor: Dr. Jeffrey Klenotic

Office: P481, Hours: T/W/TH 5-6 & by appointment

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Description: This course surveys key events, representative films, influential filmmakers, and defining film movements that mark the history of motion pictures from 1945 into the early 21st century. The emphasis is on feature-length narrative, but films in other styles are occasionally presented. In addition to providing large-screen access to major works of film art, the course facilitates historical and geographical understanding of vital contexts – industrial, cultural, social, political, national, aesthetic, and technological – that have shaped the medium’s development since the end of World War II. Students gain specialized understanding of cinema history as well as general knowledge of broad patterns in U.S. and world history.

Course Objectives: By taking this course, students will be able to:

- 1) Identify key events, films, filmmakers, and film movements that define the history of cinema since 1945.
- 2) Appreciate the global diversity of film as an art form and recognize the medium’s range of styles and functions as an aspect of cultural communication.
- 3) Understand the ways in which the development of film as an art form and medium of communication has been shaped by other forces and factors emanating from economic, technological, cultural, aesthetic, social, political and national contexts.
- 4) Explain the major changes that have occurred in the U.S. film industry since 1945.
- 5) Perform basic professional practices common in cinema arts contexts, such as preparing film program notes to accompany a screening, contextualizing a film by delivering an introduction to it, and facilitating audience discussion.

Course Attributes: CA 527 fills one of two required “Area B: Organization, History and Policy” courses in the Communication Arts Major. It can also be used to satisfy one of the two “Area II” requirements in the CA Cinema and Media Arts Option.

Course Website: This course makes regular and active use of a Canvas website. If you do not have a UNH username and password, please visit the IT office soon to set up an account.

Required Textbook: Kristin Thompson & David Bordwell, *Film History: An Introduction* [FH], 3rd edition. **This book is essential for exams.** To lower expenses, you may rent or buy a used copy. International editions may also be used, but be aware that pagination may be slightly different from what is listed in the course reading schedule. One copy of the text has also been placed on “library use only” (2 hour) reserve at the UNH Manchester library.

Additional Readings: *Film History* provides our core reading, but additional materials have been added to Canvas. You are responsible for all assigned readings. To maximize your learning, **you may find it useful to do the readings both before and after watching the movie.** Reading the material in advance helps you to see historical references and trends in the film. Reading the material a second time afterward enables you to recall scenes from the film that may be referred to in the reading.

Class Format: Each class will begin at 1pm and end at 4:50pm. Please do not disturb your classmates by chronically coming to class late or by noisily packing up your things before the end of class. The course as a whole will mix lectures, in-class screenings, homework screenings (using UNH Kanopy streaming video), readings, and discussions. Typically, the first part of class will be for discussion of the prior week’s films. This will be followed by a brief lecture/presentation of new material, along

with a new screening. **The films we watch have been chosen for historical and artistic value not entertainment value;** this means you may enjoy some films more than others. Nonetheless, you should give every film your full attention, and you are strongly encouraged to take notes as you view.

Class Discussions and Etiquette: Students are expected to come to class having completed all assigned readings and homework screenings, and ready to share their thoughts and views on the material. Film has the power to trigger many responses, and individuals can evaluate a film in different ways. One benefit of studying film historically is that though we may disagree on a film's entertainment value, we can always learn something about history from every film we see. Active participation during lecture and discussion is expected and encouraged. The main requirement is that you contribute **informed comments and pertinent questions, keep an open mind, and give attention and respect to the thoughts expressed by others in the class, especially those with whom you may disagree.** It is important to let everyone have a chance at speaking and presenting ideas in this course – in fact its small size is designed for that. It is a rare opportunity in which everyone's point of view matters. As part of this culture of respect, please refrain from making assumptions about other people's identities, beliefs, ideas, etc. Also, try to avoid speaking on behalf of any one group of people, whether you are a member of that group or not. Productive discussions are based on arguments that rely on evidence (e.g., from films we watch, other cultural artifacts, expert opinions, historical factors, etc.). Threatening or harassing behavior will not be tolerated.

Class Screenings: The experience of cinema has historically been defined by the practice of viewing moving images on a large screen in a public setting. This is the format we seek to approximate in this class. You are **required to attend all screenings** and you are expected to keep a notebook to record your thoughts and observations about each film. During screenings, you are expected to focus your attention on the film. To avoid distracting others, **students are not permitted to put their feet up onto the seat in front of them. For the same reason, eating is not permitted during screenings (drinks, sipped quietly, are okay).** So, be sure to eat something before coming to class. Also, every effort will be made to provide a full fifteen-minute break before screenings so that you can stretch your legs and grab a snack.

Electronics: Use of laptops, phones or other electronic devices is **not permitted in this class** unless mandated by the instructor. **This includes during in-class film screenings.** This policy is in keeping with [section 04:213 of the Student Handbook](#): "Regarding the policy on cell phone/PDA/pager/digital music player/laptop/other electronic device use during class, students may not use cell phones, PDAs, pagers, digital music players, laptops and other electronic devices during class unless designated by the course instructor. If use of any of these items is permitted by the course instructor, these items are not allowed to be used for non-class activities. If you, the student, have a learning disability that requires the use of one of these items, you must provide evidence from the Disability Services for Students office, to inform the course instructor of this situation so that he or she can accommodate your use. Also, if you need to leave a cell phone on for an emergency situation, you should inform the course instructor at the beginning of the class session as well as keep the phone on in a silent mode, so as not to disrupt the course."

Attendance and Lateness Policy: Attendance will be taken at the start of each class and again after each class's "intermission" break. Missing class before or after break is a half-absence. Students are allowed absences equivalent to one full class. For each half-absence beyond the limit an intermediate grade is deducted from the final course grade (e.g., an A- drops to B+). Chronic lateness counts as a half-absence. Absences beyond the one permitted will be excused only if adequate supporting documentation is provided.

Grades: In keeping with UNH's grading system, an "A" indicates "excellent" performance, "B" indicates "superior" performance, "C" indicates "competent, acceptable" performance, "D" indicates "marginal" performance, and "F" indicates "failing" performance. Intermediate grades (+/-) indicate

that work is better in some areas of evaluation than in other areas. Grades will be determined using the following scale:

A (100-92); A- (91-90); B+ (89-88); B (87-82); B- (81-80); C+ (79-78);
C (77-72); C- (71-70); D+ (69-68); D (67-62); D- (61-60); F (59 and below)

Course Requirements: Students will complete two exams (take-home, open-book) covering all scheduled film screenings (both in-class and online), lectures, discussions, and readings. In addition, students will submit one paper (2000-2500 words) or video essay (5-7 minutes) that is due at the end of the semester. Students will also work in groups to make class presentations, lead discussions, and develop screening reports relating to historical periods and films. Detailed guidelines for each assignment will be discussed in class and distributed through Canvas. **The due date and weighted value for each assignment is as follows:**

October 17 – Exam 1 (25%) Due at the start of class.

December 12 – Exam 2 (25%) Due at the start of class.

December 16 – Research Project (30%) Due by midnight.

As Assigned – Group Oral Presentation (20%)

How to submit assignments on Canvas: For work submitted on Canvas, Microsoft Word (.doc/x) or Adobe Portable Document Format (.pdf) documents are required. If you create your work using some other software, such as Apple Pages or Google Docs, use the “save as” or “export” function to save your file as a Word (.doc/x) or PDF document before uploading. Files with extensions other than .doc/x or .pdf will be considered late. Files that are corrupted or that cannot be opened will also be considered late. To upload your file, click on the “assignments” button in the Canvas menu and select the appropriate assignment. Then browse to your file, attach it, and hit submit. **It is the student’s responsibility to confirm that the instructor has received their work. Shortly after the due date, if you see a zero (0) for the assignment in your grades, this informs you that your work has not been received or has been received but cannot be opened. This means the late paper policy (described below) is now in effect.** After you have successfully uploaded your late paper, this “0” will revert to a hyphen (-) to let you know that your work has been received. Once I have finished evaluating your work, this hyphen will change to a new number that reflects your final score on the assignment. [Note: students who opt to do a video essay will have to have the file format and/or video streaming platform for submitting their work approved by me in advance.]

Policy on Late Work: Work submitted up to 7 days late will be penalized ten points (e.g. a score of 95 drops to 85). Work submitted after 7 days but before 14 days late will be penalized twenty points. After 14 days, work will no longer be accepted except in cases where a course grade of “incomplete” is merited.

UNH Policy on Academic Honesty: All work for this course must comply with [UNH policy on academic honesty](#). Violation of this policy will result, minimally, in a failing grade for this course. Plagiarism includes using someone else’s ideas or words without giving them credit. If you copy a paragraph from a book or take an idea from an article or website without telling your reader, you have plagiarized. It can be done consciously or unconsciously; both are unacceptable. Plagiarism also includes submitting someone else’s work as if it were your own, as in obtaining a paper from another student or from the Internet, or paying someone to write a paper on your behalf. Plagiarism also includes self-plagiarism, which occurs if you submit a paper or portions of a paper written for another class as if it were original to this class. If you are unsure about what does or does not count as plagiarism, please consult with me and/or review the UNH policy on academic honesty. Students should know that UNH uses “Safe Assignment.” This service searches the Internet and other databases to compare student work against online sources and other papers stored in the database.

Evaluation Criteria for Student Work: Exams, papers, and video essays will be evaluated for the quality of their *thinking*, *content*, and *form*. Excellent work will have ideas that are:

- Clearly and consistently focused around a clear question and central thesis that are informed by original and critical thinking about the topic
- Fully explained in themselves and coherently organized and logically connected to each other in support of the central thesis
- Developed incrementally from point to point using smooth, cohesive transitions
- Substantively and accurately rooted in course readings and relevant outside scholarly research as called for by the assignment
- Consistently supported by specific and well-developed details, reasons, examples, evidence, descriptions, or other forms of explication and proof
- Presented using an original title (in the case of papers and video essays) and framed by a compelling introduction that includes a specific research question and by an effective conclusion that reinforces unity by answering the research question with a strong summation of the thesis
- Nearly error-free in terms of spelling, grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and paragraphing and, in the case of video essays, exceptional in technical mechanics.
- Accurately cited using a standard reference system (e.g. APA or MLA)

Center for Academic Enrichment (CAE): Provides students with services and resources to support their academic success.

Accessibility Services: If you are a student with a documented disability or believe you may have a disability that requires accommodations, please contact Student Accessibility Services. If you think you have a disability requiring accommodations, you must register with the [Disability Services Office](#). The Disability Services Coordinator at UNHM is Jenessa Zurek. Jenessa can be contacted at (603) 641-4383, jenessa.zurek@unh.edu or in person in the Student Services Suite, Room P410H.

Mental Health Support Services: In partnership with The Mental Health Center of Greater Manchester, UNH Manchester offers consultation visits on a walk-in basis in the Academic Advising department (located in the Student Services suites, 4th floor). You may also call ahead to be placed on the walk-in schedule by contacting Academic Advising at (603) 641-4170. Services include:

- Free confidential screening & consultation with a licensed mental health therapist.
- Referrals to mental health or substance misuse treatment, and assistance in understanding how to afford additional treatment (with or without insurance!) or find free services.

If you would like to connect to counseling services directly, you may do so by contacting The Greater Manchester Mental Health Center at (603) 668-4111. If you or someone you know is experiencing a mental health or substance misuse **crisis**, please contact the Mobile Crisis Response Team (MCRT) at (800) 688-3544.

Title IX Confidentiality and Mandatory Reporting: The University of New Hampshire at Manchester and its community are committed to assuring a safe and productive educational environment for all students and for the university as a whole. To this end, the University requires UNH faculty and staff members, hall directors, resident assistants (RAs), and other students employed in leadership, supervisory, and/or mentoring roles [such as Peer Assistant Leaders (PALs), Mentor Ambassadors for Transfer Engagement (MATEs) and the Center for Academic Enrichment (CAE) mentors and tutors] to report to the University's Title IX Coordinator (Donna Marie Sorrentino, dms@unh.edu, 603-862-2930/1527 TTY) any incidents of sexual violence, domestic violence, stalking and harassment shared by students regardless of whether it occurs on or off the Manchester campus. If you wish to speak to a confidential support service provider who does not have this reporting responsibility because their discussions with clients are subject to legal privilege, you can find a list of confidential crisis centers [here](#). Please contact the crisis center that services the

town where you live. For more information about what happens when you report, how the University considers your requests for confidentiality once a report is made to the Title IX Coordinator, your rights and report options at UNH (including anonymous report options) please visit the following webpage for more information: <https://www.unh.edu/affirmativeaction/reporting-students>.

Instructor Availability: My job is to help you to learn so that you can train your thinking and expand your knowledge. I'm passionate about this work and the opportunity it affords to share the joy and power of intellectual pursuit. Please do not hesitate to visit me during office hours to discuss your ideas and review the course materials. You are also welcome to set up an appointment outside of my office hours if that works better for you. You may also contact me by office phone, via Canvas messaging, or by email (**use your UNH email account only**). I will make every effort to respond within 24 hours.

Course Outline & Reading Schedule

1. Aug. 29 Playing Its Part: Hollywood Mobilizes for World War II
Screening: *United Newsreel* (Office of War Information, US, 1944) (10m)
San Pietro (John Huston, US, 1945) (35m)
Reading: "Wartime Documentaries," **FH**, 286-290
**** Review Syllabus and Assignments ****
2. Sept. 5 Liberation in Europe & the Emergence of a New Realism
Screening: *Rome, Open City* (Roberto Rossellini, IT, 1945) (105m)
Home Viewing: *Bicycle Thieves* (Vittorio De Sica, IT, 1948) (90m)
Reading: "Postwar European Cinema: Neorealism," **FH**, 324-341; H. Salas, "Roberto Rossellini"; D. Harper, "A Noble Ruin: Remembering De Sica"
**** Discuss Oral Presentations and Assign Groups ****
3. Sept. 12 Cinema & the Mediation of Postwar Sociopolitical Problems
Screening: *The Best Years of Our Lives* (William Wyler, US, 1946) (170m)
Home Viewing: *No Regrets for Our Youth* (Akira Kurosawa, JP, 1946) (112m)
Reading: "Postwar Cinema Beyond the West," **FH**, 358-380; D. Gerber, "Heroes & Misfits"; K. Smoliak, "No Regrets for Our Youth"
4. Sept. 19 Cinema Explores the Crisis of Masculinity: "B" Films & Noir Tendencies
Screening: *Out of the Past* (Jacques Tourneur, US, 1947) (97m)
Home Viewing: *The Hitch Hiker* (Ida Lupino, US, 1953) (71m)
Writing & Thinking About Film (28m)
Reading: "The Hollywood Studio System," **FH**, 195-218; G. Morris, "*Out of the Past*: A Noir Classic"; L. Poague, "*Out of the Past*"; A. Kuhn, "Queen of the B's in a Hollywood of Drones"; W.W. Dixon, "Ida Lupino"
5. Sept. 26 Hollywood & the Challenges of Anti-Trust, Suburbanization & TV
Screening: *A Face in the Crowd* (Elia Kazan, US, 1957) (125m)
Home Viewing: *This is Cinerama* (Merian C. Cooper, US, 1952) (124m)
Reading: "Postwar Cinema," **FH**, 296-323; T. Beltzer, "*A Face in the Crowd*"

6. Oct. 3 Rise of Auteur Theory: French New Wave & Left Bank Film Movements
Screening: *La Jetée* (Chris Marker, FR, 1962) (28m)
Cleo From 5 to 7 (Agnès Varda, FR, 1962) (90m)
Home Viewing: *Breathless* (Jean-Luc Godard, FR, 1960) (90m)
Reading: “French Cinema of Postwar Decade,” **FH**, 342-351; “Art Cinema & the Idea of Authorship,” **FH**, pp. 381-402; “New Waves & Young Cinemas, 1958-1967,” **FH**, 403-421; N. Gelgud, “Happy Birthday, Pauline Kael, My Old foe”; R. Farmer, “Marker, Resnais, Varda: Remembering the Left Bank Group”
7. Oct. 10 New Cinemas from Eastern Europe: Czechoslovakia & Poland
Screening: *Daisies* (Vera Chytilová, CZ, 1966) (75m)
Home Viewing: *Knife in the Water* (Roman Polanski, POL, 1962) (96m)
Reading: “Postwar Cinema in Soviet Sphere,” **FH**, 363-370; “New Cinema in East Europe,” **FH**, 422-432; S. Shaviro, “*Daisies*”; V. Lucca, “Eat Me”
**** Group 1 Oral Presentation ****
**** Distribute Midterm Exam ****
8. Oct. 17 Cultural Rupture, Independent Cinema & the New Hollywood
Screening: *Midnight Cowboy* (John Schlesinger, US, 1969) (113m)
Home Viewing: *Black Panther* (California Newsreel Collective, US, 1968) (15m)
Betty Tells Her Story (Liane Brandon, US, 1972) (20m)
Gimme Shelter: The Rolling Stones’ 1969 Tour (Albert Maysles, Charlotte Zwerin, David Maysles, US, 1969) (93m)
Reading: “Documentary and Experimental Cinema,” **FH**, 455-469; “Hollywood’s Fall and Rise,” **FH**, 470-493; M. Moon, “Outlaw Sex and the ‘Search for America’: Representing Male Prostitution and Perverse Desire in Sixties Film”
**** Midterm Exam Due by Start of Class ****
9. Oct. 24 Political Filmmaking: New German Cinema & Lingering Fears of Fascism
Screening: *The Lost Honor of Katharina Blum* (Volker Schlöndorff and Margarethe von Trotta, WG, 1975) (106m)
Home Viewing: *Aguirre, Wrath of God* (Werner Herzog, WG, 1972) (94m)
Reading: “Politically Critical Cinema,” **FH**, pp. 494-535; “New Cinemas,” **FH**, pp. 566-598; D. Cetinich, “*Katharina Blum*: Who’s the Terrorist?”
**** Group 2 Oral Presentation ****
10. Oct. 31 Post-Colonialism & Black African Cinema
Screening: *Xala* (Ousmane Sembène, SN, 1975) (123m)
Home Viewing: *Life is Rosey* (Benoit Lamy, Mweze Ngangura, ZR, 1986) (83m)
Reading: “Black African Cinema,” **FH**, 507-509; “A Developing World,” **FH**, 599-626 (esp. 601-605); M. Diawara, “Popular Culture and Oral Traditions”; T. Gabriel, “*Xala*: Cinema of Wax and Gold”
**** Group 3 Oral Presentation ****
11. Nov. 7 Off Hollywood: Midrange Studio Films Push the Boundaries
Screening: *Do the Right Thing* (Spike Lee, US, 1989) (125m)
Home Viewing: *Stranger Than Paradise* (Jim Jarmusch, US, 1994) (90m)
Reading: “American Cinema and Entertainment: The 1980s,” **FH**, 659-691; J. Bailey, “When Spike Lee Became Scary”

12. Nov. 14 Cinema Rising: Pacific Asia & Oceania
Screening: *Memories of Murder* (Bong Joon-Ho, KR, 2003) (128m)
Home Viewing: *Sweetie* (Jane Campion, NZ, 1989) (101m)
Reading: "Cinema Rising: Pacific Asia & Oceania," **FH**, pp. 627-658
**** Group 4 Oral Presentation ****
13. Nov. 21 Hollywood & the Transition to Digital Technology
Screening: *Timecode* (Mike Figgis, US, 2000) (97m)
Home Viewing: *Tortilla Soup* (Maria Ripoll, US, 2001) (104m)
Reading: "Digital Technology and the Cinema," **FH**, pp. 713-730; S. Shaviro, "Post-Continuity: An Introduction"; B. Hallinan & C.J. Reynolds, "New Media Goes to the Movies: Digitizing the Theatrical Audience"
- Nov. 28 No Class – Holiday**
14. Dec. 5 Global Cinema Cultures & DIY Film Movements
Screening: *Italian for Beginners* (Lone Sherfig, DK/SWE, 2001) (112m)
Home Viewing: *Mutual Appreciation* (Andrew Bujalski, US, 2006) (109m)
Reading: "Toward a Global Film Culture," **FH**, pp. 691-712; "Dogme 95"
**** Distribute Final Exam ****
15. Dec. 12 Post Cinema: Affect, Convergence & Remediation in Transmedia Storytelling
Screening: *Scott Pilgrim vs. the World* (Edgar Wright, UK/JP/US, 2010) (112m)
Home Viewing: *From the Panel to the Frame: Style and Scott Pilgrim* (D. Morton Video Essay, US, 2014) (18m)
Make Transitions Count (Nerdwriter, Video Essay, US, 2016) (7m)
Reading: R. Grusin, "DVDs, Video Games, and the Cinema of Interactions"; B. Barnes, "Coming Soon to AMC Theaters: Virtual Reality Experiences"
**** Final Exam Due by Start of Class ****
**** Research Project Due in Canvas by Midnight Monday December 16 ****